Executive Summary

Workforce Attrition Patterns and Risk Hotspots - Palo Alto Networks

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Bottom line: 237 of 1,470 employees left (16.1%). Attrition is concentrated in junior, early-tenure, front-line employees who carry heavy workload. Targeted action on a few groups addresses most of the exposure.

What the data shows

- **Workload is the strongest signal.** Overtime workers leave at 30.5% versus 10.4%. Frequent travelers leave at 24.9% versus 8.0% for non-travelers. Both together: 41.9%.
- **The first two years are the riskiest.** 29.8% attrition, and 43% of all exits come from 23% of employees. Employees aged 18-24 leave at 39.2%.
- **Hotspot roles:** Sales Representatives (39.8%), Laboratory Technicians (23.9%), Human Resources staff (23.1%). The Sales department is highest at 20.6%. Senior roles are stable (2.5% to 6.9%).
- **Entry level and equity:** job level 1 accounts for 60% of exits; employees with no stock options leave at 24.4%.
- **Not drivers here:** gender, education level and time since last promotion show no statistically significant difference.

Recommended actions

- Review sustained overtime and travel load, starting with Sales and laboratory roles.
- Strengthen onboarding and check-ins for employees in their first two years.
- Diagnose the Sales Representative role (pay structure, targets, workload) before wider changes.
- Pilot equity and career-path visibility for entry-level employees.
- Monitor KPIs quarterly with the dashboard, and begin recording exit dates and reasons.

How reliable is this?

Findings describe associations in the supplied dataset, not proven causes. Several segments are small, and the data has no exit dates or reasons. Overtime and frequent travel remained strongly associated with attrition after adjusting for age, job level and tenure, which supports prioritizing them. Full methods and statistics are in the research paper.